alexandria.

investor brief

Benjamin A. Mowinckel — March 2026

Most AI investments cannot defend their terminal value. Alexandria's compounds when a new model ships.

The cognitive layer of AI — where human minds remain machine-readable across the transition.

the investment.

Five beliefs install the cheque.

> **1.** *Most AI products are transition assets — value is the gap between model capability and user need; the gap closes with every release; value decays into the model.*
>
> **2.** *Companies that survive are the ones where every model release amplifies the asset rather than absorbing it.*
>
> **3.** *Alexandria's asset is a private, accumulating, machine-readable record of how a specific person thinks — sovereign to the user, unsynthesizable from outside, compounding across years that cannot be back-filled.*
>
> **4.** *The strategic prize is the canonical write path and permission layer for those records — the convention slot, shape of WordPress, GitHub, Hugging Face. Winner-takes-most.*
>
> **5.** *Technical risk is zero. Survival risk is zero. The only existential question is demand. That is the only thing capital is for.*

Capital does not keep this company alive. It runs on ~$100/month and the founder builds regardless. *Capital accelerates the demand experiment, network density, and the first public referee for the category.* The best investor is not the largest cheque — *it is the one whose conviction creates the most leverage.* Entry price is lowest now and never returns.

the asset.

A structured, machine-readable record of who each user is — worldview, values, mental models, taste, blind spots — accumulated decision by decision through daily Socratic sessions. **Sovereign to the user. Portable across every AI provider. Worth more from every better model.**

The record cannot be back-filled. Inbox-scraping reaches what the user does, never what they mean. Five years of biographer-interviews cannot be compressed into a six-month rush. **The compounding is the years.**

Engineering is done. *One curl command, local files on the user's own machine, two integration points fire whenever the user talks to an AI — capture and inject. Ten dollars a month, free with five referred friends, slider open above.* The only open question is whether enough people want it.

the survival test.

Does this company get better or worse when the next model drops?

Most AI products degrade — coding assistants, productivity wrappers, content generators absorbed into each model release. **That is not terminal value. That is an exit timeline dressed as a multiple.**

Alexandria gets better. *Each user's record is private, accumulating, unsynthesizable from public sources. Better models extract deeper signal from the same record.* Every release is a tailwind.

In April 2026 Andrej Karpathy publicly described this architecture — *"LLM Knowledge Bases... raw data compiled into structured markdown that compounds with every model release... there is room here for an incredible new product."* **Alexandria had already shipped it.** The category will exist. The open question is who owns the protocol.

the stake.

The demand for this asset is structural, not aspirational.

AI commoditises capability — strength, intelligence, empathy in sequence. *The cultural premium on human authorship inflates as commoditisation deepens.* **The grandmother's blanket is the grandmother's blanket because she made it.** A factory robot weaving the identical blanket is not the same blanket. The people who develop the *who* behind the work capture the premium. Everyone else competes on artifacts AI can replicate.

The deeper risk is decay. *AI removes the demand on cognition; cognition only develops to the level of demand placed on it; the faculty that would notice the loss is the faculty that has weakened.* WALL-E for the body is science fiction. **WALL-E for the mind is the default trajectory.**

Keep thinking. *That is the rally and the practice. Alexandria is the gym.*

the moat.

No technical moat — by design. **Technical moats dissolve as intelligence becomes a commodity.** The moats that compound are social, cultural, and infrastructural.

The convention slot. *"If you take your thinking seriously, you have one of these."* Same shape as *"build it on WordPress," "push it to GitHub," "host it on Hugging Face."* Winner-takes-most. *12–36 month window. Move as if 12.*

The tribe. Not a network effect — an identity. *People do not leave tribes because a bigger tribe launches. They stay because of shared philosophy, the founding lineage, the handwritten letters.* **Apple can build the tool. Apple cannot build the cathedral.**

The protocol's gravity. *Every AI tool, agent, and app that reads from the user's local Alexandria directory adds switching cost. The user can leave; the ecosystem points back.*

Why frontier labs won't ship this. *Sovereignty is incompatible with their incentives — they want users in their ecosystem, not in a neutral substrate. Cross-tool credibility requires neutrality.* **Every memory feature the labs ship validates the thesis without competing with it.**

The naive moat is *"AI cannot read inside your head."* On a trajectory toward falsification — Stanford's Willett (2025) decoded inner speech at ~62 words per minute. **The real moat is interpretation, not readability.** *Decoded neural activity is generically readable but not individually meaningful; meaning lives outside the brain and requires the user's own reference frame to interpret.* BCIs are the bridge. **Alexandria builds what crosses it.**

the business.

Two streams compound on the same users.

Subscription — *$10/m baseline, slider open above. Stands alone. Break-even at 10 paying users. Prosumer comparables (Cursor, ChatGPT Pro, Notion AI) settle the slider distribution above the floor.*

Platform — *permissioned access for AI labs (alignment, personalisation), plus every service that serves a user better when it knows who they are (opt-in, revocable). Enterprises per seat; agent platforms per integration depth.* **Independent of user count.**

If	Then
~100K paying users × $50/m settled	~$60M ARR
Platform / integration revenue	~$40M+ ARR
Combined at standard 10× SaaS multiple	**$1B+ valuation**

If subscription saturates short of 100K, platform carries the upside. If platform stays narrow, subscription scales on its own. Single-mode failure risk drops.

the founder.

At pre-seed, the moat is the founder. **The cheque is on the person.**

Benjamin Mowinckel. Norwegian-American, 26. Eton, Princeton, Norwegian military, brief stint at Verdane (Oslo growth equity — carbon-removal project, then decarb sourcing). Currently in San Francisco.

No technical credentials. No previous ventures. The pitch rests on those credentials being irrelevant — *and on the company being the proof.* **Solo, running the entire stack on AI agents at $100/month opex, full-time since March 2026.** Two months from zero to engineering-done.

The hard part is not technical. *A capable team with AI could rebuild the stack in a week.* **Most AI founders solve engineering problems. Benjamin solves the framing problem.**

	$/m
Company opex	$100
Founder bare minimum	$500
Founder safe monthly	$5,000

He cannot be price-pressured. He cannot be runway-rushed. *The floor of this investment is structural — he will be working on this in five years, regardless.*

Princeton cohort, all under 27, frontier of their fields: *the founder of the RL company Anthropic uses for computer-use agents; one of the youngest macro pod leaders at Millennium; a Bain Capital associate; an Oxford PhD with the Larry Ellison Institute; the head of the Norway branch of a US defence company; a US Army Ranger candidate.* **The thinking happens inside this conversation.**

In his own words: *"I could be wrong. I doubt it. The company costs $100 a month. If I am wrong, the world loses nothing. If I am right and nobody builds this, the world loses something it did not know it needed. Either way, I am building it. I can see myself working on this for the rest of my life — through the transition and after."*

what could go wrong.

Demand untested at scale. Acknowledged. *The only open question. The only thing capital is for. Rung 1 directly answers it.*

Apple builds it. Real risk. *Also the exit thesis — category validated; Alexandria becomes the target.*

Pain not acutely felt. *Frame imposition required before conversion.* Once the record compounds, leaving feels like loss. **The acquisition problem is not "convince someone this matters." It is "make not-trying feel irrational."**

Capture bottleneck. *Most users have no digital interior.* The daily session is itself the capture mechanism. *Capture infrastructure shipped — desktop + iOS one-tap.*

Solo founder, no track record. *Mitigated by the company being its own demonstration of the thesis, the Princeton cohort, and the Karpathy-validated architecture. Not eliminated.*

Alexandria asks the user for marginal everything — marginal money, marginal time, marginal attention. Downside is zero. **The bet is conviction, not proof.**

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the ask.

Three rungs. *Investor chooses where to enter. No fixed round size.*

Rung 1 — ~$100K. *Buffers the founder in SF for ~20 months while the demand experiment runs.* If it works, the existential questions are answered. **If it fails, the loss is less than a bad pre-seed bet on an AI wrapper whose terminal value evaporates with the next model.**

Rung 2 — ~$200–500K. *Scales what works. First 1,000 users. SF presence at scale.*

Rung 3 — ~$1M+. *Platform pilot for AI labs. First public referee on the cap table.*

The company does not need the money. *The founder builds regardless.* Capital accelerates the only experiment that matters.

Returns are the long call option. Legacy is the more certain payoff.

Every protocol that mattered had a first funder. HTTP had CERN. Ethereum had Joe Lubin. The early internet had DARPA. Alexandria is the cognitive layer of AI — the protocol that makes AI think *with* you, not *for* you — and right now it is open. *The firm whose name attaches becomes the firm that goes on the page about how humans preserved thinking through the AI transition. In thirty years that page exists. The question is who is on it.*

Athens, Rome, America, Alexandria. **America protects the right to think. Alexandria protects the ability.**

Set the angels free.

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